

OSPREY ZERO / OFFLINE COLLECTION

Household readiness.

SAVE BEFORE SERVICE FAILS

A practical collection of complete guides and private planning worksheets. No signup required. This saved edition cannot provide current alerts.

Inside the collection.

Household emergency plan

Agree on how to receive warnings, where to shelter, when and where to evacuate, and how to reconnect if separated. Write the plan down and include people who need medication, mobility assistance or caregiver support.

72-hour emergency kit

Start with at least three days of safe water, ready-to-eat food, essential medicines, lighting and communication supplies. Include one gallon of water per person per day as a starting point, and account for pets, heat, medical needs and accessibility.

Go bag

Pack a portable bag with the essentials you need to leave quickly: medicines, documents, contact information, water, food, light, phone power and weather-appropriate clothing. Keep it light enough to carry and a separate grab list for items used every day.

Preparedness on a limited budget

Start with a household plan, written contacts and supplies you already own. Prioritize drinking water, essential medicines, food you normally eat and safe light. Build gradually without taking money away from urgent household needs.

Infants & children during disruption

Keep children with a trusted caregiver and plan safe feeding, water, hygiene, medicines and warmth around their age and needs. Put written contacts with each child and agree a reunion plan. Use age-appropriate feeding guidance; do not dilute formula or use unsafe water to stretch supplies.

Medicines during disrupted services

Keep essential medicines, a written medication list and the supplies needed to administer them accessible. Follow each product's storage instructions and protect medicines from floodwater, freezing and excess heat. Contact a pharmacist or clinician for a product-specific shortage or storage problem; do not change doses or substitute medicines on your own.

Evacuation with access or mobility needs

Plan movement around the person who needs the most assistance. Keep mobility aids, medicines, communication tools and essential care supplies together. Confirm accessible transport and a suitable destination directly; do not assume a shelter, lift or public rescue vehicle will be available.

Evacuating with pets

Take pets when you can evacuate safely, using a carrier or lead and a destination that accepts them. Keep food, water, medicines, identification and veterinary information together. Do not delay escape into immediate danger or reenter a hazardous building for an animal.

Edition 2026-10-02. First-aid content is source-linked editorial guidance, not independent clinical certification. Seek current training and qualified help when reachable and safe.

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Household emergency plan

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Agree on how to receive warnings, where to shelter, when and where to evacuate, and how to reconnect if separated. Write the plan down and include people who need medication, mobility assistance or caregiver support.

Do now.

**Identify local risks**

01

Use local emergency management information and plan for likely hazards.

**Choose meeting places**

02

Pick a nearby safe place and an out-of-area destination plus backup routes.

**Assign contact arrangements**

03

Name an out-of-area contact, write phone numbers and agree on check-in times.

**Practice and update**

04

Run a simple drill and revise for changes in health, school, work or pets.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Give each household member a written copy with two meeting places, two contacts and essential medical details. Practise the plan with phones off. Include a destination you can actually reach without an official shelter or rescue transport.

Watch for.

A plan that depends on one vehicle or one working phone network needs alternatives.

People & practical needs.

Write the plan in formats everyone can use: plain text, large print, translated wording or another needed communication format. Ask each person which assistance they want. Store private identity and health details securely rather than in public shared links.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Keep copies offline and in go bags. Share relevant details with caregivers and trusted contacts.

Check the next usable option

Keep copies offline and in go bags. Share relevant details with caregivers and trusted contacts.

When the first option is unavailable

Give each household member a written copy with two meeting places, two contacts and essential medical details. Practise the plan with phones off. Include a destination you can actually reach without an official shelter or rescue transport.

Questions in the field.

What if people are in different places?

Choose a nearby meeting point and a second place outside the likely affected area. Give everyone an out-of-area contact and decide how to report safe status without exposing precise locations publicly. Practice the plan without a working mobile network.

What if the chosen contact cannot respond?

Name a backup and a reassessment time before an event. Do not keep traveling between unchecked addresses. Agree what each person will do if no message gets through and who is responsible for dependents at school, work or home.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[Household emergency plan · official guidance](#)

<https://www.ready.gov/plan>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/household-emergency-plan/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

72-hour emergency kit

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Start with at least three days of safe water, ready-to-eat food, essential medicines, lighting and communication supplies. Include one gallon of water per person per day as a starting point, and account for pets, heat, medical needs and accessibility.

Do now.

**Inventory what you own**

01

Gather usable supplies before buying duplicates.

**Cover essentials**

02

Choose safe water, shelf-stable food, a can opener, light, radio, batteries and phone charging.

**Personalize**

03

Add medication arrangements, eyeglasses, infant needs, pet supplies, hygiene and accessible equipment.

**Maintain the kit**

04

Label dates, rotate food and water as instructed and check supplies routinely.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If shops close today, inventory water, shelf-stable food, medicine and batteries already at home. Put them together and write down gaps. Build a usable kit in stages; a partly stocked kit is more useful than waiting for an expensive perfect one.

Watch for.

A standard checklist is only a starting point; three days may not cover a prolonged disruption.

People & practical needs.

Start with the people in the home: drinking water, medicines, infant feeding, sensory access, safe light and pet care. Choose who will carry shared items. A 72-hour kit is a planning starting point, not a guarantee that a disruption ends after three days.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Build longer-duration supplies as space and budget allow. Keep an evacuation bag separate enough to carry.

Check the next usable option

Build longer-duration supplies as space and budget allow. Keep an evacuation bag separate enough to carry.

When the first option is unavailable

If shops close today, inventory water, shelf-stable food, medicine and batteries already at home. Put them together and write down gaps. Build a usable kit in stages; a partly stocked kit is more useful than waiting for an expensive perfect one.

Questions in the field.

How much can the household carry?

Separate supplies stored at home from a bag intended for evacuation. Test carrying the bag with the actual caregiver and mobility needs. Heavy water and duplicate tools can make a complete-looking kit unusable when movement matters.

What if a supply expires?

Use normal household rotation where suitable and record refill dates. Check battery and device compatibility before relying on them. Medicine quantities and replacements require a clinician or pharmacist rather than an improvised rationing plan.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

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72-hour emergency kit · official guidance

<https://www.ready.gov/kit>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/72-hour-kit/>

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FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Go bag

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Pack a portable bag with the essentials you need to leave quickly: medicines, documents, contact information, water, food, light, phone power and weather-appropriate clothing. Keep it light enough to carry and a separate grab list for items used every day.

Do now.

**Plan the destination**

01

Know where you can go and how you will get there.

**Pack personal essentials**

02

Include medication arrangements, identification copies, keys and accessible supplies.

**Add basic support**

03

Pack water, snacks, light, charger, hygiene supplies and appropriate clothing.

**Test and maintain**

04

Carry the bag briefly, reduce excess weight and refresh dated items.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If you have minutes rather than days, grab essential medicines, documents, shoes, water and a phone charger first. Divide necessary supplies among people who can carry them, without giving children or a person with limited mobility an unmanageable load.

Watch for.

Never delay an urgent evacuation to finish packing.

People & practical needs.

Pack for actual infants, pets, access needs and the likely transport mode. Agree which adult carries shared items and who stays with each dependent. Include a destination plan; a bag does not establish that a shelter will admit or support the household.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Keep bags accessible and plan for pets, infants and mobility equipment.

Check the next usable option

Keep bags accessible and plan for pets, infants and mobility equipment.

When the first option is unavailable

If you have minutes rather than days, grab essential medicines, documents, shoes, water and a phone charger first. Divide necessary supplies among people who can carry them, without giving children or a person with limited mobility an unmanageable load.

Questions in the field.

Does a stocked bag make leaving easier?

Only if it can be reached and carried while managing dependents. Test the load and remove duplication. Keep essential medicine, documents and mobility aids accessible; do not bury a critical item beneath optional equipment.

What if I cannot take the bag?

Leave when immediate danger requires it. Reaching safety takes priority over retrieving supplies. Keep a short written contact plan with each person and identify an alternate source of essential support ahead of time where possible.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

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[Go bag · official guidance](#)

<https://www.ready.gov/evacuation>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/go-bag/>

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FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Preparedness on a limited budget

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Start with a household plan, written contacts and supplies you already own. Prioritize drinking water, essential medicines, food you normally eat and safe light. Build gradually without taking money away from urgent household needs.

Do now.

- ☐ **Inventory before buying**
01 Check usable water containers, lights, batteries, food, clothing and charging options. Record quantities, expiry dates and gaps.
- ☐ **Choose one realistic priority**
02 Match the first purchase to a likely disruption and a person's essential need. A medicine or water gap matters more than specialist gadgets.
- ☐ **Build into normal routines**
03 Add a small amount of shelf-stable food or water when affordable. Rotate what the household actually uses and can prepare safely.
- ☐ **Make free planning changes**
04 Write emergency contacts, choose meeting places, save guides and learn safe shutoffs. Practice an exit route and check warning access.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Plan around actual carrying capacity, storage, transport and money. Identify safe mutual support before a crisis, but confirm what a neighbor or group can provide. A borrowed item is only useful when it will be accessible during the disruption.

Watch for.

Do not buy unsafe used safety equipment, store fuel improperly or ration essential medication to build a kit. No shopping list guarantees survival.

People & practical needs.

Ask each person what they need to function without power or transport. Include sensory access, infant feeding, pets and medical routines. Keep a written priority list so shared household purchases solve a real problem rather than duplicating equipment.

Keep essentials within reach.

Keep the action checklist and written contact details accessible. Use the equipment named in this guide only when available and appropriate. Assign someone to check access, batteries and expiry dates before an incident; retrieving a kit must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Revisit one gap at a time. Check a kit when food or medication rotates, after household changes and before the local hazard season.

Little storage space

Choose compact supplies that are useful in daily life, keep exits clear and identify a safe storage location.

No purchase is affordable now

Complete contacts, escape planning, guide saving and a household inventory first. Ask a trusted local support group about verified resources when safe.

Questions in the field.

Do I need a large commercial kit?

No. Start with practical needs and equipment the household can use. Compare an actual inventory with the likely disruption before buying.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

INCIDENT / SYMPTOM ONSET / LOCATION

HELP REQUESTED / RESPONSE CONFIRMED

ACTIONS / TIMES / NEXT HANDOVER

Sources & limits.

Civilian household planning. U.S. references; local conditions, services and building procedures differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[Ready.gov – Low and no-cost preparedness](#)

<https://www.ready.gov/low-and-no-cost>

[Ready.gov – Build a kit](#)

<https://www.ready.gov/kit>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/budget-preparedness/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.

Infants & children during disruption

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Keep children with a trusted caregiver and plan safe feeding, water, hygiene, medicines and warmth around their age and needs. Put written contacts with each child and agree a reunion plan. Use age-appropriate feeding guidance; do not dilute formula or use unsafe water to stretch supplies.

Do now.

- ☐ **Name the caregiver**
01 Decide who stays with each child during sheltering and travel. Use a familiar trusted backup; do not hand children to unverified helpers.
- ☐ **Protect feeding**
02 Maintain breastfeeding where applicable. Ready-to-feed formula can avoid preparation water needs when available; follow product and age-specific guidance. Do not improvise formula or change dilution.
- ☐ **Keep hygiene supplies**
03 Pack nappies, wipes, soap, clean clothing and safe water for essential care. Keep feeding equipment clean and separate from waste.
- ☐ **Keep a contact card**
04 Use necessary caregiver contact details and medical information without displaying sensitive identity details publicly. Teach older children the agreed safe contacts.
- ☐ **Use simple explanations**
05 Explain the next action calmly and specifically. Familiar routines and a comfort item can help; avoid promising that you know when danger will end.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use the caregiver plan and safe supplies already available while seeking verified medical or feeding support. Do not stretch formula with extra water or leave a child alone to find supplies.

Watch for.

Infants can deteriorate quickly with dehydration, temperature exposure or illness. Seek qualified care for concerning symptoms; do not rely on adult treatment advice.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group. Make decisions around the least mobile person, not the fastest; avoid splitting the family without a clear, safe way to reconnect. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: name the caregiver. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. Infants can deteriorate quickly with dehydration, temperature exposure or illness. Seek qualified care for concerning symptoms; do not rely on adult treatment advice.

Keep essentials within reach.

For infants & children during disruption, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Use the caregiver plan and safe supplies already available while seeking verified medical or feeding support. Do not stretch formula with extra water or leave a child alone to find supplies. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Plan quantities for the actual feeding and care routine, and ask a qualified clinician for special dietary or medical needs. Include medications and transport or sleeping arrangements.

First decision: Name the caregiver

Decide who stays with each child during sheltering and travel. Use a familiar trusted backup; do not hand children to unverified helpers. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Use the caregiver plan and safe supplies already available while seeking verified medical or feeding support. Do not stretch formula with extra water or leave a child alone to find supplies. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

Infants can deteriorate quickly with dehydration, temperature exposure or illness. Seek qualified care for concerning symptoms; do not rely on adult treatment advice. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

Keep children with a trusted caregiver and plan safe feeding, water, hygiene, medicines and warmth around their age and needs. Put written contacts with each child and agree a reunion plan. Use age-appropriate feeding guidance; do not dilute formula or use unsafe water to stretch supplies. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For infants & children during disruption, keep the specific hazard in view: Infants can deteriorate quickly with dehydration, temperature exposure or illness. Seek qualified care for concerning symptoms; do not rely on adult treatment advice.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Use simple explanations. Explain the next action calmly and specifically. Familiar routines and a comfort item can help; avoid promising that you know when danger will end. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[Ready.gov](#) · [Planning for families](#)

<https://www.ready.gov/plan>

[CDC · Infant feeding in emergencies](#)

<https://www.cdc.gov/infant-feeding-emergencies-toolkit/php/checklist.html>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/infant-child-preparedness/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.

Medicines during disrupted services

PREPAREDNESS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Keep essential medicines, a written medication list and the supplies needed to administer them accessible. Follow each product's storage instructions and protect medicines from floodwater, freezing and excess heat. Contact a pharmacist or clinician for a product-specific shortage or storage problem; do not change doses or substitute medicines on your own.

Do now.

- ☐ **Write the essential list**
01 Record the medicine name, strength, usual dose, prescriber, pharmacy and allergies. Keep a paper copy with the medicine and a copy with a trusted contact.
- ☐ **Count usable supply**
02 Track what remains and identify which medicine interruption is most urgent. Include inhalers, needles, testing supplies and batteries, not just tablets.
- ☐ **Protect storage**
03 Use the product label and pharmacist advice for temperature limits. Avoid direct heat and sunlight; do not let temperature-sensitive medicines freeze against ice packs.
- ☐ **Contact alternatives early**
04 Try a reachable pharmacy, clinician or verified medical aid provider before the supply is exhausted. Ask about the exact product; replacement rules vary.
- ☐ **Keep treatment unchanged unless advised**
05 Do not ration by skipping or doubling doses without professional direction. Seek urgent medical help for deterioration rather than trying an unverified substitute.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use the written list to seek qualified advice through a reachable pharmacy or verified clinic. Preserve safe storage and track supply. If a life-critical treatment cannot be maintained, prioritise relocation to care before the last dose or battery is used.

Watch for.

A medicine can be unsafe after heat or flood exposure even when its package looks normal. Product-specific advice matters; there is no universal safe unrefrigerated storage period.

People & practical needs.

Write names, strengths, schedules, allergies, prescriber and pharmacy contacts and any storage needs. Keep that information private and accessible to a trusted caregiver. Include supplies needed to administer the medicine, not only the package itself.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Before a disruption, agree a refill and storage plan with the prescriber or pharmacist, within local rules. If you use insulin or powered equipment, keep its specific emergency instructions with the kit.

Check the next usable option

Before a disruption, agree a refill and storage plan with the prescriber or pharmacist, within local rules. If you use insulin or powered equipment, keep its specific emergency instructions with the kit.

When the first option is unavailable

Use the written list to seek qualified advice through a reachable pharmacy or verified clinic. Preserve safe storage and track supply. If a life-critical treatment cannot be maintained, prioritise relocation to care before the last dose or battery is used.

Questions in the field.

Can a warm medicine still be used?

Storage limits depend on the exact product and whether it has been opened. Record the name, time and temperature if known and contact a pharmacist or clinician. Do not apply a generic insulin rule to every medicine or throw away an essential supply without checking safe replacement options.

What if the usual pharmacy is closed?

Keep the current prescription and medication list ready and seek a reachable licensed pharmacy or care team. Verify the source before accepting donated medicine. Do not change doses, share prescriptions or use unverified substitutes to extend supply.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

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FDA · Keeping medications safe in emergencies

<https://www.fda.gov/drugs/fda-drug-info-rounds-video/emergency-preparedness-keeping-medications-safe-feb-2016>

CDC · Diabetes care during emergencies

<https://www.cdc.gov/diabetes/articles/diabetes-care-emergencies.html>

FDA – Insulin storage during an emergency

<https://www.fda.gov/drugs/emergency-preparedness-drugs/information-regarding-insulin-storage-and-switching-between-products-emergency>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/preparedness/medication-continuity/>

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FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Evacuation with access or mobility needs

EVACUATION SHELTER / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Plan movement around the person who needs the most assistance. Keep mobility aids, medicines, communication tools and essential care supplies together. Confirm accessible transport and a suitable destination directly; do not assume a shelter, lift or public rescue vehicle will be available.

Do now.

- ☐ **Identify the actual assistance**
01 Write down transfer needs, walking distance, stairs, powered devices, communication needs and care routines. Ask the person what help is safe and useful.
- ☐ **Check the route**
02 Assess exits and stairs before a crisis. Do not use lifts in a fire or damaged building, and do not improvise a dangerous carry.
- ☐ **Confirm support**
03 Arrange more than one trusted helper and transport option. Make the responsibility specific rather than assuming someone else will come.
- ☐ **Keep essential equipment close**
04 Include medicines, charger, batteries, mobility aids and a concise care note. Keep a portable backup where possible.
- ☐ **Verify the destination**
05 Ask about step-free entry, toilets, charging, refrigeration, caregivers and service animals. A general promise of accessibility is not a confirmed arrangement.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use your confirmed private support network and a destination suited to care needs. If transport cannot be arranged, identify the safest available refuge and communicate the precise assistance required through a safe channel.

Watch for.

Do not separate a person from essential equipment or a necessary caregiver if avoidable. An untrained lifting attempt can injure both the person and the helper.

People & practical needs.

Practice the route using the actual mobility and communication aids. Keep chargers, essential medicines and written instructions together. Ask the person what works for them before moving them or their equipment.

Keep essentials within reach.

Prioritize supplies named in this guide that are usable by the person who needs them. Keep the checklist and relevant contact details accessible. Check carrying capacity, storage and equipment instructions in advance; collecting equipment must not delay the immediate protective action.

Next decisions.

Practise the plan with the person's consent and revise it when equipment or care needs change. Keep an alternative plan for power loss and an unavailable caregiver.

Check the next usable option

Practise the plan with the person's consent and revise it when equipment or care needs change. Keep an alternative plan for power loss and an unavailable caregiver.

When the first option is unavailable

Use your confirmed private support network and a destination suited to care needs. If transport cannot be arranged, identify the safest available refuge and communicate the precise assistance required through a safe channel.

Questions in the field.

What specific assistance is required?

Describe actions rather than only a diagnosis: stairs, transfers, communication, oxygen, charging, medication or a service animal. Make this information available to a trusted helper without publishing private medical details.

What if the planned helper cannot come?

Identify a second reachable support option and a safe waiting location suited to the hazard. Check it directly when possible. A generic shelter label does not establish accessibility, medical capability or permission to bring needed equipment.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

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[Ready.gov](#) · [People with disabilities](#)

<https://www.ready.gov/people-disabilities>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/accessible-evacuation/>

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FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Evacuating with pets

EVACUATION SHELTER / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Take pets when you can evacuate safely, using a carrier or lead and a destination that accepts them. Keep food, water, medicines, identification and veterinary information together. Do not delay escape into immediate danger or reenter a hazardous building for an animal.

Do now.

**Contain animals early**

01

Use a secure carrier or lead before loading or opening doors. Distress and noise can cause animals to run.

**Confirm the destination**

02

Ask whether pets are accepted and what documents or carriers are needed. Make a backup arrangement with a trusted person.

**Pack basic care**

03

Take normal food, safe water, medicines, waste supplies and a familiar blanket if readily available. Include pet water in the household total.

**Keep identification current**

04

Use a tag and a recent photo, and check microchip contact details before emergencies. Keep veterinary records privately.

**Avoid unsafe rescue**

05

Tell reachable responders where an animal may be, but do not return to fire, floodwater or active danger yourself.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use a trusted host or verified animal-care arrangement rather than assuming public shelters accept pets. Keep the family and animals together where safe and feasible.

Watch for.

A service animal and a pet may have different accommodation rules. Never leave animals in a hot vehicle while arranging shelter.

People & practical needs.

Assign a trusted adult to each person who needs assistance. Keep medicines, essential contacts and a workable reunion plan with the group. Make decisions around the least mobile person, not the fastest; avoid splitting the family without a clear, safe way to reconnect. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: contain animals early. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. A service animal and a pet may have different accommodation rules. Never leave animals in a hot vehicle while arranging shelter.

Keep essentials within reach.

For evacuating with pets, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Use a trusted host or verified animal-care arrangement rather than assuming public shelters accept pets. Keep the family and animals together where safe and feasible. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Check animals regularly for overheating, cold and distress in transport. Keep them restrained in crowded temporary accommodation and maintain hygiene.

First decision: Contain animals early

Use a secure carrier or lead before loading or opening doors. Distress and noise can cause animals to run. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Use a trusted host or verified animal-care arrangement rather than assuming public shelters accept pets. Keep the family and animals together where safe and feasible. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

A service animal and a pet may have different accommodation rules. Never leave animals in a hot vehicle while arranging shelter. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

Take pets when you can evacuate safely, using a carrier or lead and a destination that accepts them. Keep food, water, medicines, identification and veterinary information together. Do not delay escape into immediate danger or reenter a hazardous building for an animal. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For evacuating with pets, keep the specific hazard in view: A service animal and a pet may have different accommodation rules. Never leave animals in a hot vehicle while arranging shelter.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Avoid unsafe rescue. Tell reachable responders where an animal may be, but do not return to fire, floodwater or active danger yourself. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[Ready.gov · Pets and animals](https://www.ready.gov/pets)

<https://www.ready.gov/pets>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/pet-evacuation/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.